Liquid Logic — Manual

A liquid sorting puzzle for the Amstrad CPC 6128

Loading

Put the disc in drive A and type:

```
RUN"DISC
```

The loading screen appears first; the levels and the game load while you look at it (about 14 seconds). Your progress (unlocked levels and stars, options, statistics, medals, your seed) is written to the disc, in `LIQUID.SAV`, when you leave the win screen or the options and something has changed (the HUD shows `SAVING...` for a few seconds), and loaded on the next start. Files from older versions are read too. The disc must not be write-protected; if it is, the game plays normally but progress is not kept.



The loading screen

The goal

Each bottle holds layers of coloured liquid. Pour from bottle to bottle until every bottle holds **a single colour** (or is empty). A full single-colour bottle gets a cork.

A pour is allowed when the target bottle has room and is empty or has **the same colour** on top. The

whole top run of that colour moves, as much as fits. An invalid move buzzes and the bottle bounces.



A pour: the bottle flies next to the target, tilts, and the jet fills the target

Controls

Key	Action
Arrows / joystick	cursor: ← → along the row, ↑ ↓ change row
SPACE / fire	1st press: the bottle to pour **from** (it lifts); 2nd press: the bottle to pour **into** (the first one flies next to it, tilts and pours)
SPACE on the same / ESC	cancel the selection
ESC (nothing selected)	pause: ESC resume, R restart, M menu
U	undo (5 per level)
R	restart the level
E	one extra empty bottle, once, where the HUD shows E+
M	on the win, pause or time-up screen: level select

Key	Action



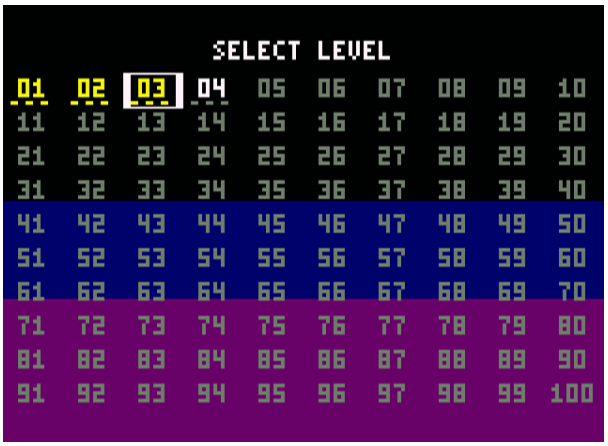
Source selected: it lifts, and the cursor moves on to the target

Screens

- **Title** — SPACE for level select, R for Relax mode, D for Relax with a seed, O for options, H for help, S for statistics.
- **Options** (O) — ↑ ↓ to choose, SPACE or ← → to change, ESC to go back. `MUSIC/SOUND FX` on/off, `SPEED` `NORMAL` or `FAST` (the bottle flies faster), `THEME` `CLASSIC` or `NEON` (unlocked after level 100), `KEYS` `REDEFINE`: press in turn the keys for left, right, up, down and fire (not ESC). The joystick always works.
- **Help** (H) — 4 pages: SPACE/→ next, ← previous, ESC back.
- **Cards** — the first time a level has a special type (ice, lock, ...), a card explains it with an example before the level starts (SPACE to go on; the clock doesn't run).
- **Statistics** (S) — levels solved, stars, perfect levels (3 stars), pours, Relax puzzles, and the 12 medals: yellow the ones you have, grey the rest. Pick one with the arrows to see what it takes.
- **Level select** — 100 cells. Grey: locked. White: available. Yellow: solved, with their stars below. Arrows and SPACE; ESC back to the title.
- **Level** — the HUD on top: `LV` level, `MOVES` moves (or `LEFT` moves remaining), `UNDO` undos left, `TIME` time, `E+` extra bottle available.



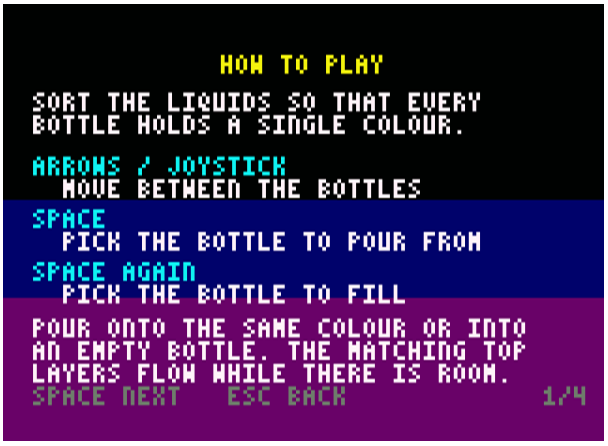
The title



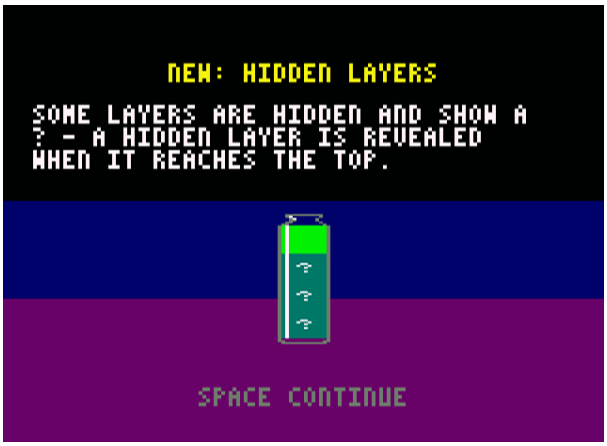
Level select: solved levels in yellow, with their stars



Options



Help, page 1



A card for a new special type



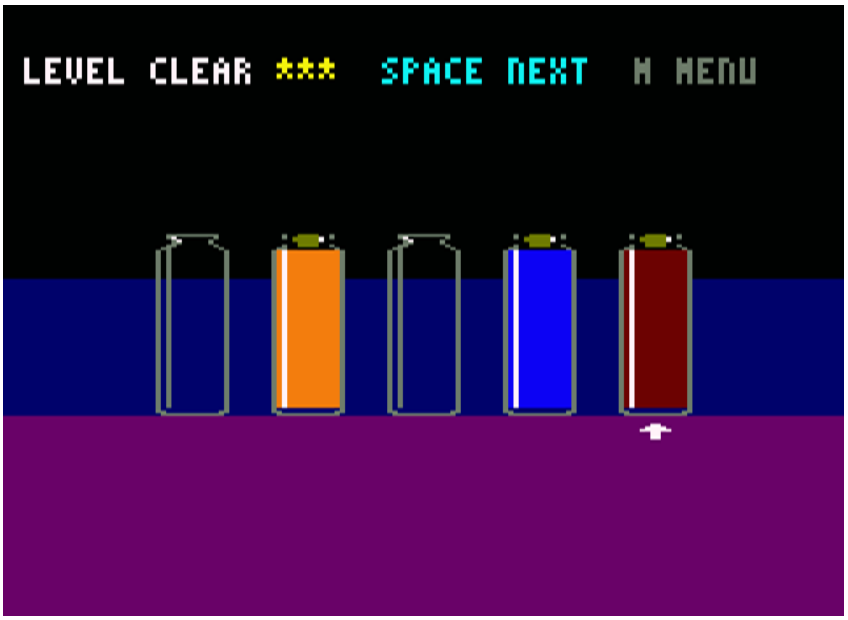
Statistics and medals

Stars

Every level has a **par**: the fewest moves the computer found.

Stars	Moves
★★★	up to par
★★	up to par + par/4 + 1
★	more

The best result per level is kept. Each solved level unlocks the next one.

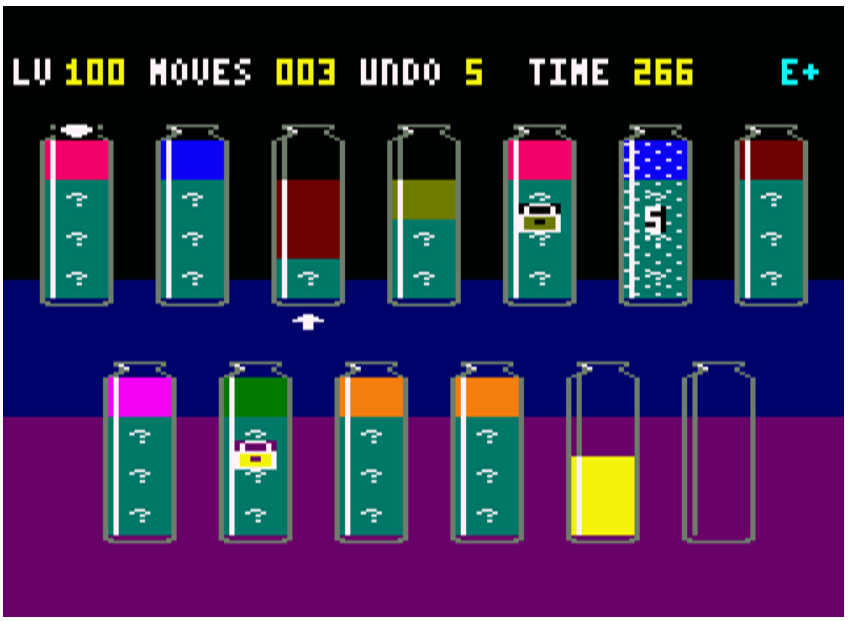


Solved: the stars, and what SPACE and M do

Special bottles and levels

What you see	What it means
Dark cyan with "?"	**hidden layer**: revealed when it reaches the top. A pour stops at it, even if it is the same colour
White crystals and a number	**frozen**: can't pour from or into it. The number drops with every move; at 0 it thaws
A padlock in a colour	**locked**: opens when a bottle of that colour is completed
White bulb on the neck	**dropper**: pours one layer at a time
Stripes over the body	**curtain**: you can't see inside until the first pour into or out of it

What you see	What it means
White notches on the walls	**different size**: holds fewer layers (one notch per layer boundary)
Thinner layers	**tall bottle**: 5 or 6 layers
`LEFT n` in the HUD	**move limit**: at 0 without a solution, U or R
`TIME n` in the HUD	**timer**: at 0, R to try again



Level 100: ice, locks, dropper, hidden layers, timer and E+

Every 10th level is a **Challenge**: several types together and one more colour.

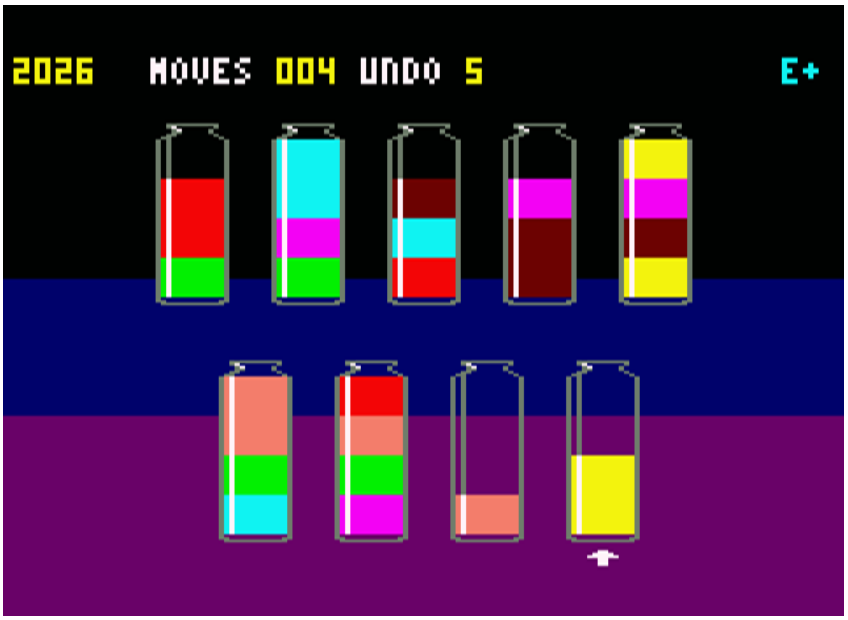
Relax mode

From the title, press **R**. Endless random levels: 5 to 8 colours, 4 layers, two empty bottles plus the extra one (E), with no special bottles, timer, stars or saving. The HUD shows `RELAX`.

Key	Action
SPACE on the win screen	next random level
R	the same level from the start

Key	Action
ESC, then SPACE	pause and get another level (if you don't like this one)
M / ESC on the win screen	back to the title

Nearly all of them can be solved; if you get stuck, use U, E or another level.



Relax with a seed: the HUD shows the seed

With a seed

From the title, press **D**. Type 4 digits (DEL erases) and SPACE or RETURN. The same seed gives the same puzzles, in the same order, on every CPC: tell a friend your seed and play the same ones. The HUD shows the seed, and the win line which puzzle of the seed you solved (e.g. `2026-3`).



The seed screen

Medals

Medal	How
FIRST DROP	your first solved level
TEN DOWN / HALFWAY / CENTURY	10 / 50 / 100 levels solved
PERFECT TEN / PERFECTIONIST	3 stars on 10 / on all levels
UNWINDING / ZEN MASTER	10 / 100 Relax puzzles
NO REGRETS	a level from 30 on without any undo
CLOSE CALL	a timed level with 10 seconds or less left
BUSY HANDS	1000 pours
GARDENER	a seeded puzzle

When you earn one, the win line alternates with `MEDAL: ....`

The ending

Solve level 100 too and press SPACE: a celebration awaits, and the **NEON** theme (black background,

pink glass) unlocks in the options.



The ending, after level 100



The NEON theme

When you're stuck

When there is no valid move, the HUD shows `NO MOVES!`. Press **U** to go back, **R** to start over, or **E** for an extra bottle where allowed.

Tips:

- Keep one bottle empty for as long as you can.
- Collect first the colours that are already on top of several bottles.
- With hidden layers, open the bottles with the fewest "?" first.